WORK-DEV

workdev Cheat Sheet

One command to open a ready-made project workspace

Run `workdev` *NAME* to open a project. Running it again reattaches to the same workspace, which keeps running in the background until you close it.

1. Commands

Table 1: Every workdev command and option.

Command	What it does
`workdev`	Pick a project from `$WORK_DIR` (uses fzf if installed)
`workdev` *NAME*	Open the project folder `$WORK_DIR/`*NAME*
`workdev` *PATH*	Open any folder by path, such as `workdev .`
`workdev` *NAME BRANCH*	Switch to git branch *BRANCH*, then open the project
`workdev -d` *NAME* [*BRANCH*]	Build the workspace without attaching
`workdev -l`	List running workspaces
`workdev -k` *NAME*	Close the workspace *NAME* completely
`workdev -h`	Show the built-in help

2. Layout

The `dev` window (window 0) has three labeled panes. A `server` window (window 1) appears only when `.workrc` sets `SERVER_CMD`.

Table 2: Panes in the dev window.

Pane	Position	What it shows
editor [*branch*]	Left	Your editor; the label shows the current git branch
shell	Top right	A plain terminal in the project folder
status	Bottom right	Live `git status` every 5 seconds, or a file listing outside git

3. Settings

Add these lines to `~/.bashrc`, then run `source ~/.bashrc` to reload it.

```
export PATH="$HOME/.local/bin:$PATH"
export WORK_DIR="$HOME/Projects"
```

Optional per-project settings go in `.workrc` in the project folder, one `KEY=value` per line. The file

is read, never executed.

Table 3: Settings recognized in a .workrc file.

Key	What it controls	Example
`EDITOR_CMD`	Editor pane (default: `$EDITOR .`)	`EDITOR_CMD=nvim .`
`STATUS_CMD`	Status pane (default: git status)	`STATUS_CMD=git log --oneline -15`
`SERVER_CMD`	Adds a `server` window running it	`SERVER_CMD=python3 -m http.server`

4. Common fixes

Table 4: Problems and how to fix them.

Problem	Cause	Fix
`workdev: command not found`	`~/.local/bin` is not on PATH, or the file is not executable	Add the PATH line above, then run `chmod +x ~/.local/bin/workdev`
"Cannot find a project"	A tilde inside quotes is not expanded	Use `"$HOME/Projects"`, not `"~/Projects"`
Only some panes appear	Panes were closed with `exit`	Run `workdev -k` *NAME*, then `workdev` *NAME*
"Not switching because of uncommitted changes"	Edits would carry over to the other branch	Run `git commit -am "message"` or `git stash`, then retry
"There is no branch named . . . "	A typo, or a branch not yet created	Pick from the list shown, or run `git switch -c` *NAME*
Editor shows old text after a switch	Files were loaded before the switch	In vim, type `:e!` and press `Enter`

Remember. To step away without losing anything, detach with `Ctrl+b` then `d` instead of exiting the panes.

© 2026 Jason Powell. Part of Work-Dev. Licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 (CC BY 4.0).